

Chapter 4: The Morning That Felt Wrong

Luna woke up with a sharp breath.

Her eyes flew open.

The ceiling.

Her room.

Everything was normal again.

Too normal.

She sat up suddenly, her heart racing.

“No... no, no...”

Her eyes moved around the room desperately.

The walls.

The window.

The silence.

No door.

Her chest tightened.

Her breathing became uneven.

“It was real...” she whispered. “It felt real...”

She held her head, trying to calm herself down.

But something was wrong.

Very wrong.

The happiness she felt last night...

Was gone.

Replaced by something heavy.

Uncomfortable.

A strange emptiness that hurt more than before.

“Kyros...”

His name slipped out of her lips without thinking.

Her eyes filled with tears.

Why did it hurt this much?

It was just a dream... right?

She got out of bed and started pacing around the room.

Back and forth.

Restless.

Frustrated.

“Why did I come back...?” she muttered.

Her mind replayed everything.

The field.

His voice.

The way he looked at her.

“I could have stayed...” she whispered.

Her chest tightened again.

“What if I made a mistake?”

That thought didn’t leave her.

It stayed.

Growing stronger.

Louder.

The whole morning felt wrong.

Even the sunlight felt dull.

The sounds around her irritated her.

Her mother's voice.

Her phone notifications.

Everything felt... too much.

She sat on her bed again, pulling her knees closer.

"What if I didn't come back...?" she whispered.

"Would I still be there... with him?"

Her heart ached at the thought.

Time passed slowly.

Too slowly.

She kept thinking.

Overthinking.

Regretting.

"Should I go back tonight...?"

The question slipped into her mind.

And it stayed.

Her fingers tightened around the bedsheet.

“What if the door appears again...?”

Her heartbeat increased.

“And what if it doesn’t...?”

That scared her even more.

“I have to try...”

Night came.

Faster than she expected.

But not fast enough.

Luna lay on her bed, staring at the ceiling.

Her heart was beating faster with every second.

“What if he’s there...?”

“What if he’s waiting...?”

“What if he’s not...?”

Her eyes slowly closed.

Not because she was sleepy.

But because she wanted to go back.

Needed to go back.

And then...

That sound.

Thummm...

Her eyes snapped open.

Her breath hitched.

The golden light.

The door.

“It’s back...”

She didn’t hesitate this time.

She ran toward it.

Opened it.

And stepped through.

The field.

The same peaceful air.

The same golden sky.

“Kyros!” she called out.

Her voice echoed slightly.

For a second...

There was no answer.

Her heart dropped.

Then—

“Luna.”

She turned instantly.

He was there.

Walking toward her.

Relief flooded through her.

Without thinking, she ran toward him.

And stopped just inches away.

Breathing heavily.

“I thought... you wouldn’t be here,” she said, her voice shaking.

Kyros looked at her quietly.

Then softly—

“I told you I’d be waiting.”

Her eyes filled again.

“I shouldn’t have left,” she whispered.

A small silence fell between them.

Then he stepped closer.

“Then don’t leave this time.”

Her heart skipped.

“I...” she hesitated.

“What if I have to?”

Kyros’s expression changed slightly.

Something deeper.

Something intense.

“Then come back again,” he said softly.

“I’ll still be here.”

They stood there, close.

Closer than before.

Time passed.

They talked again.

Walked again.

Laughed again.

But this time...

Luna felt something else.

Fear.

Because she knew...

Morning would come.

And just like before...

The light appeared.

The door.

Her smile faded instantly.

"No..."

Kyros looked at it... then back at her.

"Time's up," she whispered.

Her heart started racing again.

"I don't want to go..."

Kyros stepped closer.

Very close.

"Then don't think about it," he said quietly.

But the light grew stronger.

Pulling her back.

Her fingers tightened around his hand.

“Kyros...”

He didn’t let go immediately.

But slowly...

very slowly...

his grip loosened.

“Come back,” he said.

And just like that—

She was gone.

Luna woke up.

Back in her room.

Again.

Her chest felt heavy.

Her heart felt worse than before.

Because now...

She knew exactly what she was missing.